WORD TEMPLATE AUTHORING

A simple guide to placeholders, comments, repeating rows, evidence, and review

Build the layout in Word. Put dynamic values in {{double curly brackets}}. Put every instruction in a Word comment.

The five-minute setup

1. Design the finished page
   Set headings, labels, tables, widths, headers, footers, and fixed images in Word.
2. Add placeholders
   Type clear names such as {{Organization Name}} and {{Executive Summary}} where generated content belongs.
3. Add Word comments
   Select the placeholder or prototype row, choose Review > New Comment, and describe the evidence, format, and missing-value behavior.
4. Upload and review
   Watch the six preparation passes, then Implement, Ignore, or manually correct each useful suggestion.
5. Test generation
   Use sparse and complete evidence, download the DOCX, and confirm the layout remains useful in both cases.

> Start faster: Use template_authoring_starter.docx. It contains fixed fields, one expanding initiative table, one fixed decision table, an evidence register, and real comments you can edit.

1. Placeholders are visible fill locations

A placeholder is ordinary Word text wrapped in double curly brackets. Use a human-readable name. The name describes the meaning; it is not an exact database key.

```
Prepared for {{Organization Name}}
Reporting period: {{Reporting Period}}
{{Executive Summary}}
```

GOOD	AVOID
{{Budget Used Percent}} {{Next Meeting Date}} {{Priority Initiative}}	{{fld_22}} {{$}} {{Value}}

Choose the field shape

Field	Use for	Typical instruction
text	Short labels or names	required: true
rich_text	Paragraphs, headings, lists	Own paragraph; empty: omit if optional
number / currency / percent	Measured values	State units and evidence threshold
date	A date or reporting boundary	State the visible date format

> Current image boundary: Static images are preserved. Named image-slot replacement is not yet deterministic, so keep fixed logos in the Word template.

2. Comments are the instruction layer

Select the exact placeholder, heading, table, or prototype row. In Word choose Review > New Comment. Write normal instructions first; add directives only where they clarify behavior.

VISIBLE WORD CONTENT	WORD COMMENT

`{{Executive Summary}}`	Write two or three paragraphs for the governing body. Lead with material results.
	
	`type: rich_text`
	`required: true`
	`synthesizes: initiatives`
	`rag_search: "reporting period accomplishments"`

Scope in plain language

Scope	What it governs
binding	Only the anchored placeholder, row, or table
section	Until the next heading at the same or higher level
document	From this point to the end of the file

> Comments are read in document order. A later rule replaces an earlier rule only when they conflict. All comments and comment marks are removed from the generated DOCX.

Missing values

Use `empty: clear` to keep the layout, `empty: omit` to remove optional content, and `empty: fail` only when the document must stop. Never ask for 'Not Available from Source' as filler.

3. Build one prototype row for an expanding table

Use a repeating table when the number of items is unknown. Create one header row and one placeholder row. Anchor the collection comment anywhere in the prototype row.

Initiative	Owner	Status	Latest update	Next step
{{Initiative}}	{{Owner}}	{{Status}}	{{Latest Update}}	{{Next Step}}
cloned item 2	...	...	...	...
cloned item 3	...	...	...	...

Prototype-row comment

```
One row per active initiative with activity this period.
{Initiative} is the official name.
{Status} is On Track, Watch, or Action Required.

collection: initiatives
max_rows: 20
required: false
empty: omit
rag_search: "active initiatives status owner next milestone"
```

> Build only one empty data row. The renderer clones it for supported records and removes it when an optional collection is empty. Fixed tables simply omit the collection directive.

4. Plan evidence before writing

Comments can describe what evidence is needed and which sections must be prepared first. Ingestion reads the full comment stream, removes exact duplicate searches, and builds an execution plan.

Focused retrieval

```
Summarize operational activity for the period.
rag_search: "department accomplishments reporting period"
rag_search: "council decisions follow-up actions"
```

Write details before summaries

If a page-2 summary depends on a page-4 table, do not move the pages. Add a dependency:

```
synthesizes: initiatives
```

The system fills the initiative collection first, then writes the earlier summary from that structured result.

Evidence register

Source ID	Document	Date	Page/location	Evidence used
{{Source ID}}	{{Document Title}}	{{Source Date}}	{{Page or Location}}	{{Evidence}}

Comment the prototype row with:

```
collection: source_evidence
evidence_register: true
empty: omit
max_rows: 25
```

> The evidence register is filled from source passages actually used by the run. It should not be reconstructed from memory.

5. Upload, improve, and test

Template ingestion is a preparation workflow, not a single opaque model call. The Templates page shows live progress and retains the original Word file.

1	Inventory DOCX parts, comments, images, tables, styles, and page map
2	Compile Placeholders, scopes, fields, collections, and stable IDs
3	Deterministic review References, dependencies, duplicate guidance, and row limits
4	Model analysis Structure, content/bindings, layout, then assets/catalog description
5	Semantic review Meaning/scope, dependencies, RAG planning, layout/assets, then combined assessment
6	Validate plan Safe corrections and the pinned generation order

Review choices

Implement creates a corrected immutable Word version and re-ingests it. Ignore dismisses an irrelevant finding. Resume incomplete work reuses compatible successful checkpoints. Redo from start reruns every model checkpoint with current settings.

Test checklist

- [ ] Upload the starter and inspect its comments and authoring notes.
- [ ] Generate once with sparse evidence and once with complete evidence.
- [ ] Confirm fixed fields clear cleanly when optional values are missing.
- [ ] Confirm the initiative and evidence tables add and remove rows correctly.
- [ ] Verify comments are absent and static layout/images are preserved.
- [ ] Change one comment, upload the new version, and compare the result.

> Use the starter DOCX as a sandbox. Copy a page into your own document, rename the fields, edit the comments, and upload it as a new template version.